

A project built around care—and the chance to contribute

A note to the judges and organizers

RescueRelay matters to me because it brings a practical kind of help within reach: food that might otherwise go to waste can be directed to people and organizations that can use it.

I built RescueRelay as a coordinator-led network connecting food donors, verified nonprofit recipients, and volunteer drivers. The idea is simple, but the moment behind it is urgent. A donation has a deadline. A community organization has real limits on what it can receive. A volunteer needs clear pickup and delivery information. When those pieces are hard to coordinate, good intentions can arrive too late.

Why this work feels personal

As an international student, I know how much it can mean when support is made practical and accessible. Studying in a new country asks you to learn unfamiliar systems and find your footing. Help that is clear, timely, and offered without making someone navigate unnecessary barriers can make a real difference. That perspective shaped how I think about this project: technology should help people find one another and act, especially when time matters.

RescueRelay is one way I can turn that belief into something useful. It gives donors a way to offer surplus food, gives verified recipient organizations a clearer view of what is available, and helps volunteer drivers find and complete a run. The project includes shared rescue records, live updates across the workspace, route and distance information, and coordination tools intended to make each handoff easier to follow.

For me, this is more than a software demonstration. It is a chance to build a bridge between resources that already exist and people working to put them to use.

What this opportunity means to me

Hackathons make it possible to learn by building: to take a problem seriously, test an idea, and make it more real with the help of tools, feedback, and a community. As an international student, access to

that kind of practical support has helped me grow in confidence and ability. The encouragement and resources around a project can turn an idea that feels distant into something I can work on, improve, and share.

That is why recognition for RescueRelay would mean a great deal to me. It would affirm not only the work represented in the product, but also the value of making room for people with different backgrounds to contribute solutions to shared challenges. I am grateful for the opportunity to build, learn, and present an idea that connects technology with community care.

The impact I hope to make

I hope RescueRelay can help make food rescue easier to coordinate, more transparent for the people involved, and dependable enough to earn trust. Winning would be meaningful encouragement to keep improving it and to continue learning how thoughtful technology can support real people doing important work.

Thank you for considering both the project and the personal meaning behind it.

Prepared as supplemental context for judges and hackathon organizers. Personal details are intentionally kept general so the author can add any specific experience they wish to share.